



JANUARY 14, 2026 COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING -A AGENDA

Date: Wednesday January 14, 2026
Time: 6:00 PM
Location: 108 E Green Street Council Chambers 3rd Floor
Watch Online: <https://www.youtube.com/@CityofIthacaPublicMeetings>

- 1. Cooperative Working Relationships Training 5-6 PM**
- 2. Call To Order**
 - 2.1. Emergency Evacuation Notice
 - 2.2. State of the City Address
 - 2.3. Agenda Review
- 3. Review and Approval of Minutes- No Minutes to Approve**
- 4. Public Works and Operations**
 - 4.1. [Cass Park Pavilion and Restroom Improvements](#)
- 5. Intergovernmental Relations**
 - 5.1. [Professional Conduct and Council Oversight](#)
- 6. Meeting Wrap-Up**
 - Announcements
 - Meeting Adjourned

No Public Comments

Not all meetings have a Public Comment segment. The City of Ithaca wants to hear from you! You are encouraged to share your thoughts with Common Council using the options below:

To Submit Written Comments please use the link below.

[Click Here to Submit Written Comments](#)

*Written comments submitted will be compiled and entered into the record.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Dept of Public Works-Engineering
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING -A
FROM: DPW Engineering Division
DATE: January 14, 2026
RE: Cass Park Pavilion and Restroom Improvements
ITEM #: 4.1

Seeking updated funding resolutions for approved Capital Projects.

ATTACHMENTS:

[Work Session Memo to Council_Cass Park Pavili_John Licitra.pdf](#)
[Cass Park Pavilion and Union Field Bathroom R_John Licitra.docx](#)
[Detailed Memo Combined_GH_John Licitra.pdf](#)



MEMORANDUM

Date: 15 December 2025

To: Common Council

From: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer, DPW—Engineering Division

RE: Cass Park Pavilion and Bathroom Project

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Existing Cass Park Capital Projects #929 & #934 seek funding increases to construct replacement infrastructure: 1 large pavilion, 2 bathroom buildings (near Children's Garden & at Union Field), and associated site improvements. If the budget is increased, then construction could begin in March 2026 with substantial completion scheduled for July 2026.

PROJECT HISTORY, BACKGROUND, & ANALYSIS

Cass Park was constructed during the early 1970s and these structures have seen limited improvements since this time. Improvement recommendations to the identified structures were made in the 2002 Thomas Assoc Building Assessment Program and the 2022 Barton and Loguidice Cass Park Master Plan. The roofs have leaks, are missing shingles and are beyond expected life, bathrooms are not up to current ADA standards, the pavilion and buildings have evidence of rot, the storage space is inadequate for maintaining park equipment and supplies and the diesel generator for the field lights requires 10-12 gallons of diesel per hour to operate, is over 10 years past its replacement date (2013) and is extremely inefficient and loud. The public demands usable facilities.

POLICY ALIGNMENT STATEMENT

This project aligns with the City's goal of being more accessible to all community members. It continues the City's mission and compliance with the Comprehensive Plan to maintain existing City infrastructure. Significant outside funding totaling \$0.96M was obtained via:

- \$0.5M NYS Office of Parks, Rec., and Historic Preservation grant
- \$0.3M Sen. Lea Webb's Community Resiliency, Economic Stability & Tech. grant
- \$0.085M Ithaca Urban Renewal Agency Community Dev. Block grant (expected Jan 7, 2026)
- \$0.075M NYS Energy Research Dev. Agency grant



CITY OF ITHACA | WORK SESSION MEMO

QUESTIONS FOR COUNCIL

- If the project is not funded, then what happens to the existing grants and future grant opportunities?
- If the project is not funded, then should the facilities be temporarily closed and portable toilets be contracted?
- If the project is not completed, the needs will remain, designs will need to be revisited/updated resulting in additional costs and the project costs projections will continue to rise a minimum of 5 percent annually.

BUDGET IMPLICATIONS & FUNDING

The City 2024 budget passed the initial funding for these projects. This project was originally bid in May 2025 and came in \$1.1M over budget. In efforts to make the project affordable while meeting the identified needs of the project we shifted to utilizing cooperative buying agreements to use pre-cast buildings and a pavilion via Purchase Orders. Bids opened again in Nov 2025 for a total project cost of \$2.1M and a funding gap remains of \$359,700. This gap in funding would be covered via capital bonding.

REQUIRED PUBLIC AMENITIES

The pavilion and adjacent restrooms are heavily utilized and are the only restrooms in that area of the park that serves 2 pavilions, a playground, the Black Diamond Trailhead, special events, Union Field and Cayuga Waterfront Trail users. The Union Field Restroom Building serves Union Field, Cayuga Waterfront Trail users and Special Events. This building will also provide cold storage for park equipment that often has to be stored outdoors.

NEXT STEPS

Additional information is found in the attached memo and budget details. A resolution is drafted to increase the funding at the 4 Feb 2026 CC meeting.

A Resolution to Amend Capital Project #929 for Cass Park Pavilion and Bathroom and Capital Project #934 Union Field Bathroom and Storage Project

WHEREAS, Capital Project #929 was established in the 2024 budget to design the replacement of the 1970s Cass Park Pavilion and Bathroom, and

WHEREAS, Common Council has received a grant of \$500,000 from NYS Office of Parks, Recreation, and Historic Preservation (OPRHP) for the project to subsidize part of the construction costs and the current authorization of \$50,000 is not sufficient for the design costs, and

WHEREAS, Common Council increased the budget authorization to \$988,000 in April 2025, and

WHEREAS, Capital Project #934 was established for the Union Field Bathroom and Storage Replacement with a budget authorization of \$578,150 in 2024 budget authorization, and

WHEREAS, CREST grant of \$300,000 and NYSERDA Clean Energy Communities Grant of \$74,500 was received by City staff for Union Field Bathrooms project, and

WHEREAS, the Ithaca Youth Bureau operates and maintains the Cass Park Pavilion and Bathroom, and Union Field Bathrooms, and Engineering staff, and the City's design consultant, Barton & Loguidice, have estimated design, construction, and construction support costs totaling \$2,085,350 and

WHEREAS, Engineering staff has vetted and will continue to value-engineer the above replacement estimates in a timely manner to allow for the fiscal use of limited City resources and the vital services these amenities provide, and the budget increase will enable for construction administration, inspection, material testing and a construction contingency; now, therefore be it

RESOLVED, That Common Council hereby amends Capital Project #929 by \$ 246,198 for the project, bringing the total authorization to \$ 1,234,198; and, amends Capital Project #934 by \$ 273,002 for the project, bringing the total authorization to \$ 851,152 be it further

RESOLVED, That funds needed for said amendment shall be derived from [issuance of Serial Bonds], and be it further

RESOLVED, Common Council hereby authorizes the Superintendent of Public Works to execute contracts with the qualified low bidders for the approved Cass Park Pavilion and Bathroom project.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-5690

Office of City Engineer

Telephone: 607 / 274-6530

Fax: 607 / 274-6415

To: Common Council
From: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer – DPW
Gregg Houck, Director – Ithaca Youth Bureau
Date: 18 Dec 2025
Re: Cass Park Capital Improvement Project: Amendment to Pavilion
and Bathroom Replacement Project

Please find enclosed a resolution to amend and increase the Capital Budget for the replacement of Cass Park Pavilion & Restroom (CP# 929), and Cass Park Union Field Restroom & Storage facility (CP# 934).

Background: Common Council funded the Cass Park Capital Plan in 2020 to assess the current and future needs for using the park's existing buildings and grounds. In June 2024, Common Council increased the funding for CP#929 to \$988,000. An additional NYSERDA grant increased the funding for CP#934 to \$706,650. Both projects were designed and scheduled for concurrent construction schedules to take advantage of economies of scale – combined budgets equal \$1,640,650. Phasing the project would increase cost about 25%.

The multi-prime contract bids opened on May 8, 2025 and the qualified low bidder contracts totaled \$1,097,740 over budget. The design team ratified the scope and used existing cooperative buying agreements to directly purchase replacement pre-cast buildings (CXT) and a pavilion (Parkitects). Remaining work items include demolition of existing structures, underground and overhead utility connections, building pad preparation, masonry, asphalt, and site restoration. Bids opened on Nov 6, 2025 and a funding gap remains of \$359,700.

Grant Information:

- NYS Office of Parks, Recreation and Historic Preservation	\$500,000.
- Lea Webb endorsed Community Resiliency, Economic Sustainability, and Technology Program (CREST)	\$300,000.
- Ithaca Urban Renewal Agency Community Dev. Block	\$85,000.
- NYSERDA Clean Energy Communities <u>Grant</u>	\$ 74,500.
SUM	\$ 959,500.

Quick Stats:

Pavilion Restroom & Pavilion:

- Pavilion 40' x 64' with electric hook-ups and lights (solar ready)
- 26' x 20' Building & Storage
- 4 all gender bathrooms (2 ADA-accessible)
- Income generating Large Pavilion Rentals

Union Field Restroom & Storage Building:

- 26' x 30' Building & Storage (solar ready)
- Removes diesel generator for field lighting
- 4 all gender bathrooms (2 ADA-accessible)
- Stores rec. equipment and maintenance items for 32 athletic fields

Project Timeline:

Original Project Budget = \$1,694,500

Bid Opening May 8, 2025 = \$2,793,00 (over budget by \$1,097,740),
Not awarded

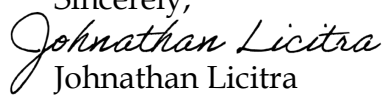
Re-design, cooperative buying agreements (Sourcewell & HGAC)
for precast buildings

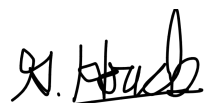
See Addendum document for detailed breakdown

Bid Opening Nov 6, 2025 = over budget by \$359,700

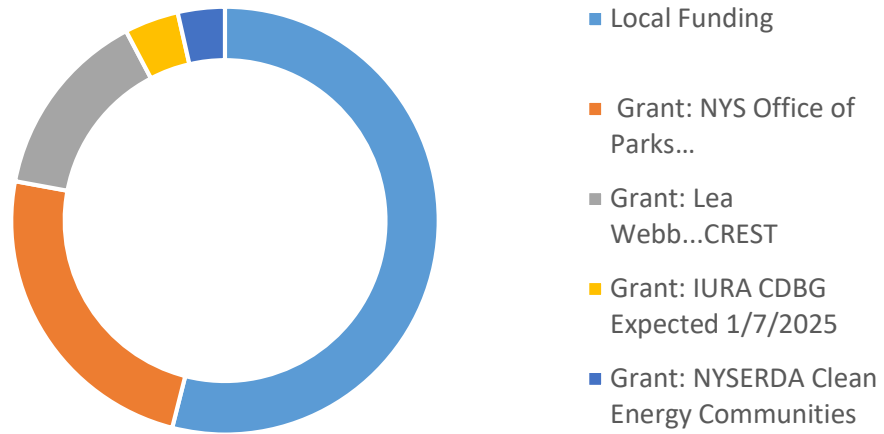
Current: Seeking updated CC Resolution for funding gap

Additional Information: With the bid letting, the City has requested an extension to Award the contract until Feb 6. The City has also signed three Purchase Orders to obtain the precast structures. With the \$959,500 grant, the City's local costs would be \$1,214,850 or 54% of the total project costs. Due to the nature of rising construction costs, past delayed repairs, and an expressed need from the community for improvements to Cass Park's amenities, it is highly encouraged to do this work. As a partial grant reimbursement project, the City will be paid back after expenditures. The resolution is written as such to pass the resolution in the affirmative will fund the full provisions \$2,085,350. Please do not hesitate to contact me if you should have any questions.

Sincerely,

Johnathan Licitra
Civil Engineer, City DPW


Gregg Houck
Director, Ithaca Youth Bureau

FUNDING SOURCES: CASS PARK PAVILION & BATHROOM IMPROVEMENTS



Budget Details:

Based upon 11/21/2025 Estimates

CP#929

Pavilion & Bathroom

\$ 50,000 CC 2024 Budget
 \$ 500,000 NYS Office of Parks...
 \$ 438,000 CC June 5 2024
 \$ 85,000 IURA CDBG Expected 1/7/2025

\$ 1,073,000 Subtotal

Sum Budget Both \$ 1,725,650

Planned Expenses

\$ 128,100 Design Cost
 \$ 45,000 Const Support & Inspection
 \$ 335,333 PO CXT Precast Building & Tie-ins
 \$ 193,265 PO Parkitects Wood Pavilion & Labor
 \$ 3,000 Temporary Portable Toilets (TPT)

\$ 704,698 Subtotal Planned Cost

Bid Opening 11/6 for Demo/ Site Work/ Building Pad & Utility Installations

\$ 432,000 General Contractor
 \$ 54,300 Electrical Contractor
 \$ 43,200 Contingency

\$ 529,500 Subtotal Bid Cost

Total Cost Both \$ 2,085,350

\$ (161,198) Balance

CP#934

Union Field

\$ 300,000 Lea Webb... CREST
 \$ 278,150 CC 2024 Budget
 \$ 74,500 NYSERDA Clean Energy Communities

\$ 652,650 Subtotal

Planned Expenses

\$ 81,500 Design Cost
 \$ 30,000 Const Support & Inspection
 \$ 417,252 PO CXT Precast Building & Tie-ins
 \$ 20,000 NYSEG Transformer and Connections
 \$ 5,700 Temp. Storage Units & TPT

\$ 554,452 Subtotal Planned Cost

\$ 228,000 General Contractor
 \$ 45,900 Electrical Contractor
 \$ 22,800 Contingency

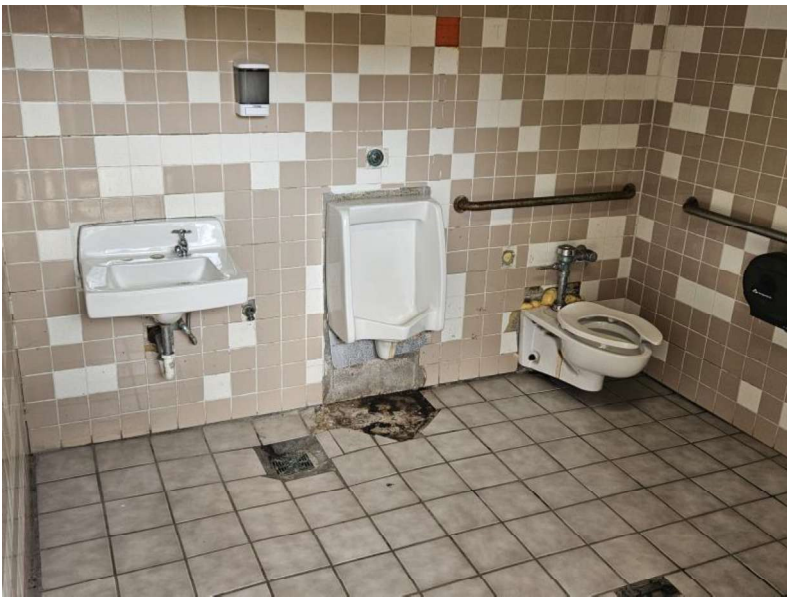
\$ 296,700 Subtotal Bid Cost

\$ (198,502) Balance

Sum Funding Gap Both \$ (359,700)



Current Bathrooms at Pavilion Area





Current Large Pavilion





Restroom/Storage Building at Union Field





Design for New Large Pavilion





Material Look for New Restroom/Storage Building



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Mayor's Office
Shaniqua Lewis, Deputy City Clerk

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING -A
FROM: Mayor Robert Cantelmo
DATE: January 14, 2026
RE: Professional Conduct and Council Oversight
ITEM #: 5.1

Resolution Affirming Council Support for City Staff and Establishing Professional Conduct and Oversight Protocols

ATTACHMENTS:

[Resolution Affirming Council Support for City Staff and Establishing Professional Conduct and Oversight Protocols.pdf](#)

Resolution Affirming Council Support for City Staff and Establishing Professional Conduct and Oversight Protocols

WHEREAS, the Common Council of the City of Ithaca recognizes that City employees are the foundation of effective, transparent, and equitable governance; and

WHEREAS, the integrity, professionalism, and institutional knowledge of City staff are essential to maintaining continuity of operations and public confidence in municipal government; and

WHEREAS, the Council acknowledges that administrative staff must be free to perform their duties without undue political pressure or interference; and

WHEREAS, it is the responsibility of the Common Council to provide clear policy direction, adopt budgets, and conduct oversight consistent with the City Charter while maintaining appropriate boundaries with administrative personnel; and

WHEREAS, the Council is committed to restoring trust, professionalism, and respect between the legislative and administrative branches of city government; now, therefore, be it

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby reaffirms its deep gratitude to all City staff for their continued service, dedication, and resilience, and recognizes their central role in sustaining the daily operations and success of the City of Ithaca; and

RESOLVED, that the Common Council reaffirms that City staff are accountable to the City Manager or other appropriate supervisors under the Charter, and that the Council's proper role is to establish policy, adopt budgets, and provide oversight through defined procedures; and

RESOLVED, that City staff who experience or witness inappropriate political pressure, harassment, or undue interference from any member of Council shall have the right to report such incidents directly and confidentially to the Mayor, who shall review and, if warranted, refer the matter to the City Attorney, Human Resources, or the Common Council for appropriate follow-up; and

RESOLVED, that to preserve Council's legitimate oversight authority, any request for the presence of City staff before Council for the purpose of providing detailed operational information shall require a written request by three (3) members of Council submitted to the Mayor with at least five (5) business days' notice prior to a meeting, identifying the specific topic of inquiry and the questions to be addressed; and

RESOLVED, that upon receipt of such a request, the Mayor shall coordinate with the appropriate department head or City Manager to arrange staff participation at a regular meeting, ensuring that the inquiry remains limited to the defined subject matter and consistent with the Charter's separation of powers; and

RESOLVED, that the Common Council shall exercise its oversight role through established best practices, including:

- (a) obtaining information through the Mayor, City Manager, or City Clerk;
- (b) directing all operational inquiries to staff through appropriate administrative channels;

- (c) conducting oversight hearings only on well-defined policy or fiscal subjects; and
- (d) refraining from public commentary or statements that disparage individual staff or departments; and

RESOLVED, that “aldermanic interference” is hereby defined as any action by an individual member of Council that (1) directs, commands, coerces, or attempts to influence the day-to-day administrative decisions of City staff; (2) seeks to bypass established supervisory hierarchies; or (3) uses one’s elected position to obtain preferential treatment, privileged information, or special consideration from staff outside of formal processes; and

RESOLVED, that violations of these professional standards shall constitute misconduct under the Council’s Code of Conduct, and may result in written reprimand, formal censure, temporary suspension of direct staff access privileges, or removal from liaison or external appointments; and

RESOLVED, that a censure shall require a majority vote of the full Council; and

RESOLVED, that all such actions shall be documented in the Council record and transmitted to the City Clerk for inclusion in the official proceedings; and

RESOLVED, that nothing herein shall be construed to limit the Mayor’s Charter or Council-authorized policy functions, including the authority established by the “2025–2026 Mayoral Advisory Committees and Legislative Priorities” resolution, or to restrict staff participation in policy research, drafting, or advisory work conducted under the Mayor’s direction in their role as the City’s chief elected official and executive agent of the Common Council; and

RESOLVED, that nothing herein shall restrict the participation of City staff in Council-authorized committees, working groups, or similar bodies provided such participation occurs with the knowledge of the Mayor and the City Manager and is limited to providing technical, policy, or operational expertise at the request of those bodies; and

RESOLVED, that the Mayor shall transmit this resolution to all City employees and include it in annual ethics and conduct briefings for elected officials and department heads, ensuring shared understanding of the standards of conduct, oversight, and mutual respect that underpin effective municipal service.